

Pivotum

THE CAREER INDEX · FALL 2026 EDITION

AI exposure, scored for every career.

Every career, scored

How we score. Every career is rated 1–10 for AI exposure, where 10 is most at risk — the same six factors and the same weights applied to all 28, so a vet and a paralegal are measured the same way. The score reflects exposure to what AI can already do, not how much any employer has chosen to deploy.

What the bar shows. Each runs from a field's most protected role to its most exposed, because the biggest risk isn't picking the wrong field — it's picking the wrong path inside it. The same job title routinely holds both a safe career and a doomed one. As a rule, the safe end is unpredictable, hands-on and human-accountable; the exposed end is whatever can be reduced to a screen.

CAREER SAFEST 0 10 MOST EXPOSED RANGE

A SAFE PATH IS THERE FOR THE TAKING

Even the most protected role in these fields scores low. The exposure only shows up if your kid drifts toward the screen-based corner of the work.

Medicine 2.1 – 4.9

Surgery and the bedside are the safest work we score; radiology, read off a screen, is the exposed edge.

Dentistry 2.3 – 5.5

Hands in a mouth stay safe — it's the dental lab bench that quietly automated a decade ago.

Nursing 2.4 – 5.4

The protection lives at the bedside, not the qualification; telehealth triage scores nearly double.

Veterinary Medicine 2.4 – 5.4

A patient that can't describe anything keeps clinical work safe; lab and diagnostic roles are the exposed corner.

Skilled Trades 2.5 – 5.0

The moat was never 'working with your hands' — it was working somewhere unpredictable. A production line isn't.

Allied Health 2.5 – 6.1

Bodies, trust, licensure and unpredictability at once; the screen-based corner scores far higher.

Teaching



3.1 – 6.8

A classroom isn't an information-delivery problem; teaching through a screen is a different trajectory entirely.

Social Work



3.3 – 6.1

Protected by something rarer than a license — statutory authority over a person's life; case coordination is the exposed part.

Construction



3.3 – 7.4

On the site, one of the safest jobs there is; in the office attached to it, one of the most exposed.

Psychology



3.5 – 7.1

A license makes it one of the safest careers; the bare degree lands in ordinary graduate exposure — the widest promise-vs-reality gap we score.

SAFE OR EXPOSED — THE PATH DECIDES, NOT THE FIELD

Each of these holds a protected career and a doomed one under the same job title. Which one your kid ends up in comes down to the track they choose.

Engineering



3.9 – 6.3

Point technical aptitude at the physical world (a PE and a site) and it's safe; point it at a CAD desk and it isn't.

Agriculture



4.0 – 6.2

Hands-on farm management holds; the tech-forward 'precision ag' version is the more exposed one.

Hospitality



4.0 – 8.0

Human presence substantially is the product; only the back-office booking desk is heavily exposed.

Transport



4.1 – 7.3

The office job coordinating the vehicles scores higher than anyone actually driving one.

Translation



4.3 – 8.8

Court and medical interpreting stays safe; general document translation is the single most-exposed job in the index.

Pharmacy



4.4 – 6.4

The surprise of healthcare — fully licensed and clinical, yet the most exposed health profession bar radiology.

Law



4.5 – 7.9

The widest split of any licensed profession — the trial litigator is safe, the document-review associate isn't. Both are lawyers.

Finance		4.6 – 8.0
It protects the person in the room with the client, and offers almost nothing to the analyst preparing the materials.		
Architecture		4.7 – 7.6
The stamp and the site are real protection; the drafting years that used to lead there are automating out from under it.		
Computer science		4.7 – 8.1
Not dying — its entrance is. Safe at the senior end on judgment; the entry rung is the second-highest score in the index.		
Business & Management		4.9 – 7.6
The most-taken degree points at the exposed end; the protected destinations exist, but the route runs through the jobs being automated.		
EXPOSED EVEN AT ITS MOST PROTECTED		
The whole field skews exposed and the safe corner is narrow. Not off-limits — but go in clear-eyed about where the value has already moved.		
Life Sciences		5.0 – 7.2
The terminal is more exposed than the bench — the computational branch and the bare degree score highest.		
Cybersecurity		5.0 – 7.4
Safer than most of tech because the adversary keeps changing — but 'safer than software' isn't 'safe.' Tier-one work is exposed.		
Journalism		5.1 – 8.3
Original reporting is barely touched; desk aggregation sits near the top — though the industry's real problem predates AI.		
Accounting		5.2 – 7.9
It all turns on the license — the CPA signature is a legal monopoly; the bookkeeping beneath it is among the most automatable work we score.		
Marketing		5.5 – 8.2
No license, no physical requirement, no structural moat — every bit of protection sits at the senior end and has to be earned.		
Graphic Design		5.6 – 8.4
The one field where AI took the craft itself — production design is the single most-exposed job; only direction holds.		

Closest to the technology, and it didn't protect it — entry analysis is among the most exposed work in the index.

Green marks a genuinely low-exposure entry (≤ 4.0); red, one that's highly exposed (≥ 6.5). Re-scored every six months — we publish where we might be wrong.

Where to go from here

Twenty-eight fields is a shortlist, not a verdict. Three steps, and each one narrows the map for your family.

- 1 This index is the lay of the land.** Every field scored the same way — enough good directions here to start the conversation about which paths are worth walking, and which begin in a hole.
- 2 The free Career Map is the signpost.** Pick the career your kid keeps circling back to and open its free Career Map — a first look at where the safe and exposed tracks sit, and the six factors that decide which is which.
- 3 Winning in the Age of AI is how you act on it.** Your living Career Map re-scored as the field moves, the reps that build real judgment, and a pod in your exact lane — the community that turns the read into your opening instead of just watching the ground shift.

Start free at pivotum.ai/community